

**CALIFORNIA REGIONAL WATER QUALITY CONTROL BOARD
CENTRAL VALLEY REGION**

ORDER NO. 93-237

**WASTE DISCHARGE REQUIREMENTS
FOR
CITY OF CERES
WASTEWATER TREATMENT PLANT
STANISLAUS COUNTY**

The California Regional Water Quality Control Board, Central Valley Region, (hereafter Board) finds that:

1. The City of Ceres (hereafter Discharger), operates a wastewater treatment and disposal facility. The property (Assessor's Parcel No. 41-083-4000) is owned by the City of Ceres.
2. Waste Discharge Requirements Order No. 75-279, adopted by the Board on 21 November 1975, prescribes requirements for a discharge from the City of Ceres for disposal by ponding and irrigation.
3. Order No. 75-279 is neither adequate nor consistent with current plans and policies of the Board.
4. Order No. 79-53 established wastewater reclamation requirements for treated effluent from the City to be used for off-site crop irrigation. The contract to supply irrigation water to the neighbor expired and will not be renewed by the City. Order 79-53 was rescinded by the Board on 4 December 1992.
5. The Discharger discharges 2.2 million gallons per day of aerated lagoon effluent to conventional evaporation/percolation ponds. Total average daily design flow is 2.5 million gallons per day. Turlock Irrigation District is proposing to build a 49.9 MW power plant near the City's wastewater treatment plant. The power plant is designed to use 0.3 million gallons per day treated effluent from the City.
6. The facility is in Section 22, T4S, R9E, MDB&M, with surface water drainage to the San Joaquin River, as shown in Attachment A, which is attached hereto and part of the Order by reference.
7. The Board adopted a Water Quality Control Plan, Second Edition, for the Sacramento-San Joaquin Basin (hereafter Basin Plan), which contains water quality objectives for all waters of the Basin. These requirements implement the Basin Plan.

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8. The beneficial uses of the San Joaquin River are municipal, industrial, and agricultural supply; recreation; esthetic enjoyment; navigation; and preservation and enhancement of fish, wildlife, and other aquatic resources.
9. The beneficial uses of underlying ground water are domestic, industrial, and agricultural supply.
10. The action to update waste discharge requirements for this facility is exempt from the provisions of the California Environmental Quality Act (CEQA), in accordance with Title 14, California Code of Regulations (CCR), Section 15301.
11. This discharge is exempt from the requirements of Title 23, CCR, Section 2510, et seq. (hereafter Chapter 15). The exemption, pursuant to Section 2511(b), is based on the following:
 - a. The Board is issuing waste discharge requirements, and
 - b. The discharge complies with the Basin Plan, and
 - c. The wastewater does not need to be managed according to 22 CCR, Division 4, Chapter 30, as a hazardous waste.
12. The Board has notified the Discharger and interested agencies and persons of its intent to prescribe waste discharge requirements for this discharge and has provided them with an opportunity for a public hearing and an opportunity to submit their written views and recommendations.
13. The Board, in a public meeting, heard and considered all comments pertaining to the discharge.

IT IS HEREBY ORDERED that Order No. 75-279 is rescinded and the City of Ceres, its agents, successors, and assigns, in order to meet the provisions contained in Division 7 of the California Water Code and regulations adopted thereunder, shall comply with the following:

A. Discharge Prohibitions:

1. Discharge of wastes to surface waters or surface water drainage courses is prohibited.

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2. Bypass or overflow of untreated or partially treated waste is prohibited.
3. Discharge of waste classified as 'hazardous' or 'designated', as defined in Sections 2521(a) and 2522(a) of Chapter 15, is prohibited.

B. Discharge Specifications:

1. The monthly average dry weather discharge flow shall not exceed 2.5 million gallons/day.
2. Objectionable odors originating at this facility shall not be perceivable beyond the limits of the property owned by the Discharger.
3. As a means of discerning compliance with Discharge Specification No. 2, the dissolved oxygen content in the upper zone (1 foot) of wastewater in ponds shall not be less than 1.0 mg/l.
4. The treatment facilities shall be designed, constructed, operated, and maintained to prevent inundation or washout due to floods with a 100-year return frequency.
5. Ponds shall be managed to prevent breeding of mosquitos. In particular,
 - a. An erosion control program should assure that small coves and irregularities are not created around the perimeter of the water surface.
 - b. Weeds shall be minimized through control of water depth, harvesting, or herbicides.
 - c. Dead algae, vegetation, and debris shall not accumulate on the water surface.
6. Public contact with wastewater shall be precluded through such means as fences, signs, and other acceptable alternatives.
7. Ponds shall have sufficient capacity to accommodate allowable wastewater flow and design seasonal precipitation and ancillary inflow and infiltration during the

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nonirrigation season. Design seasonal precipitation shall be based on total annual precipitation using a return period of 100 years, distributed monthly in accordance with historical rainfall patterns. Freeboard shall never be less than two feet (measured vertically to the lowest point of overflow).

8. On or about 1 October of each year, available pond storage capacity shall at least equal the volume necessary to comply with Discharge Specification 7.

C. Sludge Disposal:

1. Collected screenings, sludges, and other solids removed from liquid wastes shall be disposed of in a manner that is consistent with Chapter 15, Division 3, Title 23, of the California Code of Regulations and approved by the Executive Officer.
2. Any proposed change in sludge use or disposal practice from a previously approved practice shall be reported to the Executive Officer and U.S. Environmental Protection Agency (EPA) Regional Administrator at least 90 days in advance of the change.
3. Use and disposal of sewage shall comply with existing Federal and State laws and regulations, including permitting requirements and technical standards included in 40 CFR 503.

If the State Water Resources Control Board and the Regional Water Quality Control Boards are given the authority to implement regulations contained in 40 CFR 503, this Order may be reopened to incorporate appropriate time schedules and technical standards. The Discharger must comply with the standards and time schedules contained in 40 CFR 503 whether or not they have been incorporated into this Order.

4. The Discharger is encouraged to comply with the State Guidance Manual issued by the Department of Health Services titled *Manual of Good Practice for Landspreading of Sewage Sludge*.
5. By 30 January of each year, the Discharger shall submit a sludge disposal plan describing the annual volume of sludge generated by the plant and specifying the disposal practices.

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D. Ground Water Limitations:

The discharge shall not cause underlying ground water to:

1. Contain waste constituents in concentrations statistically greater than background water quality. (For purposes of comparison, background water quality shall be determined when background monitoring provides sufficient data. Quality determined in this manner establishes "water quality protection standards.")
2. Contain chemicals, heavy metals, or trace elements in concentrations that adversely affect beneficial uses or exceed maximum contaminant levels specified in 22 CCR, Division 4, Chapter 15.
3. Exceed a most probable number of total coliform organisms of 2.2/100 ml over any seven-day period.
4. Exceed concentrations of radionuclides specified in 22 CCR, Division 4, Chapter 15.
5. Contain taste or odor-producing substances in concentrations that cause nuisance or adversely affect beneficial uses.
6. Contain concentrations of chemical constituents in amounts that adversely affect agricultural use.

E. Provisions:

1. The Discharger shall comply with the Monitoring and Reporting Program No. 93-237, which is part of this Order, and any revisions thereto as ordered by the Executive Officer.
2. The Discharger shall comply with the "Standard Provisions and Reporting Requirements for Waste Discharge Requirements", dated 1 March 1991, which are attached hereto and by reference a part of this Order. This attachment and its individual paragraphs are commonly referenced as "Standard Provision(s)."
3. In the event of any change in control or ownership of land or waste discharge facilities described herein, the Discharger shall notify the succeeding owner or operator of the existence of this Order by letter, a copy of which shall be immediately forwarded to this office.

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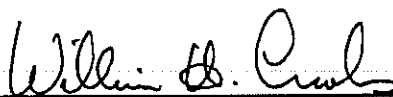
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4. At least **90 days** prior to termination or expiration of any lease, contract, or agreement involving disposal or reclamation areas or off-site reuse of effluent, used to justify the capacity authorized herein and assure compliance with this Order, the Discharger shall notify the Board in writing of the situation and of what measures have been taken or are being taken to assure full compliance with this Order.
5. The Discharger shall use the best practicable cost-effective control technique currently available to limit mineralization to no more than a reasonable increment.
6. The Discharger must comply with all conditions of this Order, including timely submittal of technical and monitoring reports as directed by the Executive Officer. Violations may result in enforcement action, including Regional Board or court orders requiring corrective action or imposing civil monetary liability, or in revision or rescission of this Order.
7. The City of Ceres as owner of the real property at which the discharge will occur, is ultimately responsible for ensuring compliance with these requirements.
8. A copy of this Order shall be kept at the discharge facility for reference by operating personnel. Key operating personnel shall be familiar with its contents.
9. If reclaimed water is used for construction purposes, it shall comply with the most current edition of "Guidelines for Use of Reclaimed Water for Construction Purposes". Other uses of reclaimed water not specifically authorized herein shall be subject to the approval of the Executive Officer and shall comply with 22 CCR, Division 4.
10. The Board will review this Order periodically and will revise requirements when necessary.

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I, WILLIAM H. CROOKS, Executive Officer, do hereby certify the foregoing is a full, true, and correct copy of an Order adopted by the California Regional Water Quality Control Board, Central Valley Region, on 3 December 1993.



WILLIAM H. CROOKS, Executive Officer

9/27/93:SPD:gs/ldj

**CALIFORNIA REGIONAL WATER QUALITY CONTROL BOARD
CENTRAL VALLEY REGION**

MONITORING AND REPORTING PROGRAM NO. 93-237

**FOR
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Specific sample station locations shall be established under direction of the Board's staff and a description of the stations shall be attached to this Order.

EFFLUENT MONITORING

Effluent samples shall be collected at the discharge to ponds.

<u>Constituents</u>	<u>Units</u>	<u>Type of Sample</u>	<u>Sampling Frequency</u>
20°C BOD ₅	mg/l	Grab	Monthly
Nitrates (as NO ₃)	mg/l	Grab	Monthly
Specific Conductivity	μ mhos/cm	Grab	Monthly
Chloride	mg/l	Grab	Monthly
Flow	mgd	Cumulative	Daily

WASTEWATER POND MONITORING

The freeboard on all percolation/evaporation ponds shall be observed and recorded twice monthly. The minimum freeboard observed during each month at each pond shall be reported together with the dates when the freeboard was observed.

WATER SUPPLY MONITORING

A sampling station shall be established where a representative sample of the municipal water supply can be obtained. Water supply monitoring shall include at least the following:

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<u>Constituents</u>	<u>Units</u>	<u>Sampling Frequency</u>
Standard Minerals	mg/l	Yearly
Electrical Conductivity @ 25°C	μ mhos/cm	Yearly
Total Dissolved Solids	mg/l	Yearly

GROUND WATER MONITORING

The ground water monitoring program shall consist of the three on-site monitoring wells. Ground water samples shall be collected from all wells and analyzed as follows:

<u>Constituents</u>	<u>Units</u>	<u>Sampling Frequency</u>
Specific Conductivity	μ mhos/cm	Quarterly
pH	pH Units	Quarterly
Nitrate (as NO ₃)	mg/l	Quarterly
Chloride	mg/l	Quarterly
Groundwater Elevation	Feet, MSL ⁽¹⁾	Quarterly

¹ Ground water elevations shall be reported to the nearest 0.01 foot above mean sea level.

REPORTING

In reporting the monitoring data, the Discharger shall arrange the data in tabular form so that the date, the constituents, and the concentrations are readily discernible. The data shall be summarized in such a manner to illustrate clearly the compliance with waste discharge requirements.

Monthly monitoring reports shall be submitted to the Regional Board by the 20th day of the following month.

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The results of any monitoring done more frequently than required at the locations specified in the Monitoring and Reporting Program shall be reported to the Board.

Upon written request of the Board, the Discharger shall submit a report to the Board by **30 January** of each year. The report shall contain both tabular and graphical summaries of the monitoring data obtained during the previous year. In addition, the Discharger shall discuss the compliance record and the corrective actions taken or planned which may be needed to bring the discharge into full compliance with the waste discharge requirements.

The Discharger shall implement the above monitoring program as of the date of this Order.

Ordered By: William H. Crooks
WILLIAM H. CROOKS, Executive Officer

3 December 1993
(Date)

9/27/93:SPD:gs/ldj

INFORMATION SHEET

CITY OF CERES WASTEWATER TREATMENT PLANT STANISLAUS COUNTY

The City of Ceres operates a wastewater treatment plant in Section 22, T4S, R9E, MDB&M.

Influent passes through a "Muffin Monster" grinder, through aerated facultative ponds, followed by disposal to evaporation/percolation ponds.

Total average daily design flow for the plant is 2.5 million gallons per day (mgd). Turlock Irrigation District is proposing to have a 49.9 MW power plant built near the treatment plant. The power plant is designed to use 0.3 mgd treated effluent from the City.

Local soils are typical of valley fill areas (i.e., silty sand underlain by a thin hardpan layer, then more silts). Local ground waters are maintained 6 to 10 feet below ground surface by the irrigation district through pumps at each section corner. These pumped waters are discharged to irrigation water canals for further use as irrigation water. Residences are widely separated. The surrounding area is devoted to agriculture.

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